

Albert Li

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EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Bachelor of Arts, Major in Psychology

Vancouver, BC

Sep. 2023 – May 2027 (Expected)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

1. Li, A. Z. K., Alford-Duguid, D., & Ongchoco, J. D. K. (2026). Shadows as derivative individuals. Talk given at the annual meeting of the *Society for Philosophy & Psychology*, 6/19/26, Baltimore, MD, USA.
2. Li, A. Z. K., Alford-Duguid, D., & Ongchoco, J. D. K. (2026). When two become one: A “same-object advantage” that spans across shadows and their casting objects. Talk given at the annual meeting of the *Vision Sciences Society*, 5/16/26, St. Pete Beach, FL, USA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UBC Perception & Cognition Lab

Research Assistant — PI: Dr. Joan Ongchoco

Vancouver, BC

July 2025 – Present

- Developed a first-author research program with Dr. Joan Ongchoco and UBC philosopher Dr. Dominic Alford-Duguid, investigating whether and how shadows are bound to their casting objects in visual processing.
- Designed and programmed online experiments in jsPsych and created high-control 3D stimuli in Blender (~600 images across 40 scenes).
- Collected large-scale behavioural datasets across seven experiments (>1,900 participants), with additional preregistered studies in progress.
- Analyzed data in R and produced figures and results supporting conference presentations and a first-author manuscript in preparation.

UBC Social Cognition & Emotion Lab

Research Assistant — PI: Dr. Elizabeth Dunn

Vancouver, BC

August 2026 – Present

- Running two independent studies examining human–AI interaction in social relationships: how AI feedback influences romantic conflict resolution and how AI-generated versus self-written apologies affect apology use.
- Developed and deployed online studies in Qualtrics; coordinated participant recruitment and data collection through Prolific.

UBC Visual Cognition Lab

Project Lead — PI: Dr. Ronald Rensink

Vancouver, BC

March 2025 – Present

- Led an undergraduate research team investigating how dot-level visual encodings (size, shape, luminance, colour) affect perceived correlation judgments in scatterplots.
- Trained and supervised junior researchers; delegated tasks, tracked milestones, and ensured adherence to standardized protocols.
- Standardized procedures for data collection and documentation; implemented checklists and training materials to improve consistency and reduce errors.
- Coordinated study deployment and participant recruitment; monitored data integrity and troubleshooted technical issues during collection.

ACADEMIC AWARDS & HONOURS

Trek Excellence Scholarship

University of British Columbia

2026

Quinn Research Travel Grant

University of British Columbia

2026

SPP Travel Award

Society for Philosophy & Psychology

2026

Dean's Scholar

University of British Columbia

2024 – Present

RESEARCH WORKSHOP

CVR Vision Science Summer School

June 2026

Centre for Vision Research, York University

Toronto, ON

- One of 18 students selected from 170 applicants for a fully funded, five-day residential program in vision science.
- Attended lectures by world-leading vision scientists spanning human visual perception, visual neuroscience, computer vision, machine learning, and disorders of vision.
- Completed hands-on, tutorial-style research projects; participated in panel discussions on scientific careers and the use of AI as explicit, testable models of brain computation.

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Sense Ability Pediatric Occupational Therapy

Vancouver, BC

Behaviour Interventionist

November 2024 – Present

- Provided one-on-one behavioural interventions to children with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) using Applied Behaviour Analysis (ABA) techniques.
- Collected and recorded data on children's progress and behaviours to assist in the modification of individualized intervention strategies.

UBC Centre for Student Development & Leadership

Vancouver, BC

Senior Orientation Leader

August 2026 – September 2026

- Led a team of 19 Orientation Leaders who collectively supported 245 first-year students.
- Trained and supported Orientation Leaders, focusing on leadership development, effective communication, teamwork, and problem-solving.

Orientation Leader

August 2025 – September 2025

- Provided first-year students with support, community-building, and timely resource referrals to aid their transition to university.
- Supported engaging learning environments by leading icebreakers and designing challenges for a learning community of 36 students.

UBC Recreation

Vancouver, BC

Facility Staff

May 2025 – September 2025

- Supported day-to-day gym operations across UBC's three recreation centres, including facility supervision and front-line patron assistance.
- Assisted gym users with equipment-use questions, facility policies, and gym etiquette to help maintain a safe, welcoming, and inclusive recreation environment.

BC Association for Advancing Communications

Vancouver, BC

Camp Leader

July 2025

- Worked one-on-one with a child with ASD who communicates using a TouchChat AAC (Augmentative and Alternative Communication) device, modeling language and supporting communication during daily activities.
- Collaborated with speech-language pathologists, educators, and families to implement AAC strategies that fostered the child's autonomy, literacy, and social connection.

Canada's Wonderland

Vaughan, ON

Food and Beverage Supervisor / Bar Supervisor

July 2022 – August 2024

- Led teams of 20+ associates across high-volume restaurants and bars at Canada's largest amusement park, coaching staff to strengthen service quality and teamwork.

Elections Canada

Toronto, ON

Registration Officer

September 2021

- Welcomed voters and guided them through the registration and voting process during the 2021 Canadian Federal Election.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: JavaScript (jsPsych)

Statistical Software: R, SPSS

Software: Blender, Excel, Adobe Photoshop, Keynote

Coursework: Java (CPSC 210: Software Construction), Racket (CPSC 110: Systematic Program Design)